The Mantra and Rite by Which Building a Single Stūpa Becomes the Building of Ten Million

Toh 921 · Derge Kangyur

མཆོད་རྟེན་གཅིག་བཏབ་ན་བྱེ་བཏབ་པར་འགྱུར་བའི་སྔགས་དང་ཆོ་ག

This short work, whose Tibetan title opens with homage to the Buddha Vairocana, King of Light, and continues "de la mchod rten gcig btab na bye ba btab par 'gyur ba'i sngags dang cho ga," may be rendered in English as "The Mantra and Rite by Which Building a Single Stūpa Becomes the Building of Ten Million." No Sanskrit title is preserved in the opening lines. It is a brief ritual manual that sets out a series of mantras addressed to Vairocana, to be recited over the clay and other materials used in making stūpas or caityas, over the clay lumps and the powder placed inside the caitya mould, and when writing mantras. It promises that through this practice the merit of building one stūpa is multiplied ten million times. The text is Toh 921 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī and mantra texts associated with the practice of making small votive stūpas.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Vairocana, King of Light.

Here is the mantra by which building a single stūpa becomes the building of ten million, and its rite. Over all the materials, the clay and the rest, one should recite this mantra twenty-one times:

oṃ namo bhagavate vairocana prabha rājāya tathāgatāya arhate saṃmyaksaṃbuddhāya tadyathā oṃ sūkṣame sūkṣame same samaye śānte dānte asamārope anālaṃpe taralave yaśvavati mahātejo nirākule niravāṇe sarva buddha adhiṣṭhāna adhiṣṭhite svāhā

The mantra to be cast seven times over the clay for building caityas, or when writing mantras: namaḥsmanta buddhānāṃ oṃ vajra āyuṣe svāhā

The mantra for the clay lumps: oṃ vajrod bhavaya svāhā

The mantra for putting powder inside the caitya mould and inside the tsa-tsa, or for smearing it with sesame oil: oṃ araje viraje svāhā

The mantra for inserting the seal or the mantra: oṃ dharma dhātu garbhe svāhā

The mantra for placing the clay lump in the caitya mould: oṃ vajra dhātu garbhe svāhā

The mantra for striking it with the mallet and pressing it: oṃ vajra muṅgara ākoṭaya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā

The mantra for taking it out of the caitya mould: oṃ dharma rate svāhā

The mantra for setting on the wheels and the crowning finial: oṃ bhramaṇaye svāhā

The mantra for seating the caitya in the maṇḍala: oṃ supratiṣṭhata vajra svāhā

If the rite is performed in this way, then by building one caitya one will have built ten million. In all one's births one will remember one's former lives. If, with the hand that made the maṇḍala still covered in clay, one anoints whatever place is in pain, all the eighteen kinds of leprosy and other diseases, without exception, will be cured.

The dhāraṇī by which building a single stūpa becomes the building of ten million is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The term rendered "clay lumps" is uncertain. From its use (it is placed into the caitya mould, struck and pressed) it appears to be the lump of clay from which a small votive stūpa is moulded. "Tsa-tsa" is the small moulded clay votive image or stūpa. The powder is presumably dusted into the mould and onto the tsa-tsa to keep the clay from sticking. The "wheels" here are taken as the rings of the stūpa's spire, set on together with the crowning finial, rather than a ritual diagram. The syllables read as "mantra for" in that line are written in a way that is evidently a scribal slip for the usual word for "mantra." The text's closing syllable after "complete" has been left untranslated as a scribal flourish.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.